

FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER

Phase 2 · Film #4 (Saga Film #12)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	12 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #4)
Phase	Phase 2
Real title	<i>CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER</i> (the name of the 616 storyline)
Decoy / codename title	" <i>COLD STORAGE</i> "
Release date	Friday, April 4, 2014
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Directors	Anthony & Joe Russo
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 164 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + 1970s-style paranoid conspiracy thriller

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	TYRESE AVERY (Captain America, film 2 of the franchise)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Steve Rogers / Captain America	Tyrese Avery	32
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow	Harmony Divine	31
Bucky Barnes / The Winter Soldier	Sebastian Stan	31
Sam Wilson / The Falcon	Anthony Mackie	35
Sharon Carter / Agent 13	Emily VanCamp	27
Gen. Aleksander Lukin	Mads Mikkelsen (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	48
The Red Skull (<i>voice and flashes of his face, inside Lukin's mind</i>)	Hugo Weaving	54
Brock Rumlow / Crossbones	Frank Grillo	48
Nick Fury	Samuel L. Jackson	65
Agent Jasper Sitwell	Maximiliano Hernández	40
Peggy Carter (<i>elderly; a cameo in aging makeup</i>)	Hayley Atwell	31
Thanos / Mistress Death (<i>post-credit</i>)	Josh Brolin / Aubrey Plaza	46 / 29
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a Smithsonian guard</i>)	Stan Lee	91

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	" <i>Winter Soldier</i> ", Ed Brubaker & Steve Epting, <i>Captain America</i> vol. 5 #1–14 (2005–06): the Red Skull's assassination by the Winter Soldier, Aleksander Lukin, the Cosmic Cube, the Skull's mind trapped inside Lukin, the Philadelphia attack, and Cap using the Cube to give Bucky back his memories.
Supporting comics	<i>Captain America</i> #117 (1969): the Falcon · <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #75 (1966): Sharon Carter, Agent 13 · <i>Captain America</i> #359 (1989): Crossbones · Brubaker's <i>Captain America</i> (2005–08): the Winter Soldier and Black Widow's shared history in the Red Room
Nerf check	✓ The Winter Soldier matches Cap blow for blow, and his cybernetic arm is stronger. Cap wins through Bucky's own heart, not by physically overpowering him. That's the 616 ending.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97%. Brubaker's "Winter Soldier" is adapted almost issue for issue.

Straight from the page:

- **Bucky survived the 1945 explosion.** He lost his left arm and was pulled out of the sea by a **Soviet submarine**. The Soviets gave him a **cybernetic arm**, **brainwashed him**, and **kept him in cryogenic storage between missions** for decades as **the Winter Soldier** (#1–8).
- **General Aleksander Lukin**, ex-Soviet and head of the **Kronas Corporation**, was the Winter Soldier's last handler (#1).
- **Lukin gets the Cosmic Cube** (#1).
- **The Winter Soldier assassinates the Red Skull**, whose consciousness escapes **into the Cube** and then **into Lukin's mind** (#1–7).
- **The Winter Soldier attacks Philadelphia** (#3).
- **Natasha Romanoff trained alongside the Winter Soldier in the Red Room** (Brubaker). They **have a past together** (616).
- **Cap uses the Cosmic Cube to give Bucky his memories back.** Bucky remembers who he is, is horrified by what he's done, and **shatters the Cube** before vanishing (#14).
- **The Falcon**, Sam Wilson, is Cap's partner (#117). **Sharon Carter, Agent 13**, is Peggy's niece (616).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Red Skull's body comes from the WWII stasis chamber (the *Captain America* mid-credit scene) | MCU continuity. On 616 the Skull had come back decades before 2005. |

| The Cube comes from A.I.M. (the *Captain America* post-credit scene) | MCU continuity. On 616 A.I.M. built the Cube. |

| Crossbones (1989) appears in the Brubaker story | He's part of Brubaker's run (2005–07) |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Captain America	Peak human; master tactician; the shield	A hallway fight against twenty agents, jumping out of a Quinjet without a parachute, leading a S.H.I.E.L.D. strike team	–	✓ 100%
The Winter Soldier	Peak-human conditioning (a partial Soviet super-soldier treatment); a cybernetic arm with superhuman strength ; master assassin , marksman and knife fighter; stealth; decades of experience (vol. 5 #1–14)	All of it: he rips the door off a moving car, catches Cap's shield one-handed , and makes a mile-long sniper kill	–	✓ 100%
Black Widow	Red Room training; master spy and fighter; the Widow's Bite	Infiltrating Kronas; fighting Crossbones to a standstill	–	✓ 100%
The Falcon	Winged flight harness ; expert acrobat and fighter; Redwing , his falcon, bonded to him by a telepathic link (#117)	Aerial combat; Redwing (a real trained falcon, with VFX only for flight stunts)	–	✓ 100%
Aleksander Lukin / the Red Skull	Master strategist; billionaire industrialist; the Skull's mind inside him	The Skull takes over in flashes (Lukin's face distorts in reflections)	–	✓ 100%
The Cosmic Cube	Reality-altering : whatever the holder wants (ToS #79)	It restores Bucky's memories	–	✓ 100%
Crossbones	Mercenary and expert hand-to-hand fighter	Fights Cap and the Widow	–	✓ 100%
Sharon Carter	Elite S.H.I.E.L.D. agent	Runs covert operations against Kronas	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A Soviet ghost story turns out to be true. The assassin who has shaped the last fifty years of history is the best friend Captain America buried in 1945.
Theme	You can't freeze the past. Steve and Bucky both lost decades. Only one of them remembers.
Villain / antagonist	Aleksander Lukin / the Red Skull (main); the Winter Soldier (a victim who's been turned into a weapon); Crossbones

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE GHOST

- **Monday, January 13, 2014.** Cap splits his time between the Avengers and S.H.I.E.L.D. strike missions, working with **Agent 13, Sharon Carter**, and with **Natasha Romanoff**, who has **defected to S.H.I.E.L.D.** since the end of *The Avengers*.
- He visits **Peggy Carter**, old and fading, in a D.C. care home. She's Sharon's aunt.
- **The Red Skull's stasis bunker** in Bavaria is raided. The Skull's body is taken, and hours later **he's assassinated** by a masked gunman with a **metal arm**.
- Natasha goes pale. In the Red Room they had a name for him: **the Winter Soldier**.

ACT TWO: THE WINTER SOLDIER

- The trail leads to **General Aleksander Lukin** and his **Kronas Corporation**, who bought **the Cosmic Cube** from A.I.M.'s remnants.
- At the moment of the Skull's death, **his mind went into the Cube, and from the Cube into Lukin**. Lukin hears a second voice in his head now.
- Cap meets **Sam Wilson**, a counselor at the VA and a former pararescueman, and **the Falcon** joins him.
- **The Winter Soldier attacks Philadelphia**, a bombing that kills hundreds and is blamed on S.H.I.E.L.D.
- On a burning overpass, **Cap and the Winter Soldier fight**. The mask comes off. **It's Bucky**. *"Who the hell is Bucky?"*
- **Natasha** tells Steve everything. She trained alongside Bucky in the Red Room and loved him, before they wiped his mind again.

ACT THREE: THE CUBE

- Lukin, **half Red Skull now**, plans to use the Cube to remake the world.
 - Cap, the Widow, the Falcon and Agent 13 **storm Kronas's Siberian facility**.
 - **Cap vs. the Winter Soldier, round two**. Cap drops his shield: *"I'm not going to fight you. You're my friend."*
 - Cap **takes the Cosmic Cube** and uses it for one thing only: **"Remember."**
 - **Bucky remembers**. Every mission, every face, 1945, and Steve. He's horrified.
 - He **shatters the Cube** with his metal fist.
 - **The Red Skull's voice screams inside Lukin**, then goes quiet. Lukin is taken into custody. Crossbones escapes.
 - **Bucky disappears into the Siberian snow**.
 - Steve stands at Peggy's bedside. She doesn't know him today. He holds her hand anyway.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, January 13, 2014 → Saturday, March 15, 2014. The post-credit scene is undated.
Where it's set	Washington, D.C. · Avengers Mansion, NYC · Bavaria (the Skull's bunker) · Philadelphia · Moscow (Red Room flashbacks) · Siberia (Kronas's facility) (filmed in Washington, D.C., Philadelphia and Finland)
Relative to other films	Three months after <i>Fantastic Four</i> . Johnny Storm's Times Square "4" billboard is on screen, and Sam jokes about it.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The Winter Soldier**, the **Red Room**, and **Kronas**.
- **The Falcon** and **Redwing**; **Sharon Carter**; an aging **Peggy**.
- **Steve's grief**: the man out of time finds the one friend who came through with him.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Black Widow is now S.H.I.E.L.D.	She defected after the <i>Avengers</i> epilogue	<i>Avengers</i> #16 era (<i>Avengers 2</i>)
Hawkeye	Natasha takes a call and smiles: " <i>Barton says she's sick of waiting for an invitation.</i> "	<i>Avengers 2</i> (Hawkeye breaks into Avengers Mansion, as on 616, <i>Avengers</i> #16)
The Winter Soldier on the loose	Bucky disappears	Phase 3
Crossbones	Escapes	Phase 3

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
The Cube is gone	Bucky shatters it	On 616, the Cosmic Cube was the first thing Thanos went after (<i>Captain Marvel</i> #27–33)
Thanos turns to the Gems	The post-credit scene	The Cube is out of the picture, so the Gems are his only path.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	 "NATALIA." A snowbound train station in Russia. Bucky , hood up, stares at a departures board. A voice behind him: <i>"You were always bad at hiding, James."</i> Natasha , alone. BUCKY (not turning): <i>"...Natalia."</i> She sits beside him, not touching. Neither of them leaves.
Post-credit scene	 "THE CUBE." Thanos's throne on the dead world. A glowing shard drifts in front of him, the last fragment of the Cosmic Cube, flickering out . Thanos watches it die. Death stands silent beside him. THANOS: <i>"The humans broke the Cube. So be it."</i> He raises the Infinity Gauntlet , which now has one Gem in place, and looks at the five empty settings . THANOS: <i>"The Gems, then."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "LAYOVER." Post-credit: "SPARE PARTS."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline